



BIOMETRICS

The science of measuring and analyzing people's physical characteristics for identification purposes is known as biometrics. Some companies may require a secure authentication process to gain entry. Biometric systems work in the same way. First, an image or recording of a person's specific trait, such as an iris or a fingerprint, is taken. Computer software reads it and turns it into a code or graph. When the person next visits, the system compares the trait with the stored data to determine whether it is the same person.



"A HUMAN BEING IS A SINGLE BEING. UNIQUE AND UNREPEATABLE."

Eileen Caddy (1917-2006),
Egyptian-born author

DNA

Deoxyribonucleic acid (DNA) is found inside body cells and is the material that makes up genes. Comprised of long chains paired in a double helix, DNA works like a code carrying all of the instructions for how the body works. Police use DNA taken from blood, hair, and any other body tissues to discover the identity of people involved with a crime scene.

VOICE

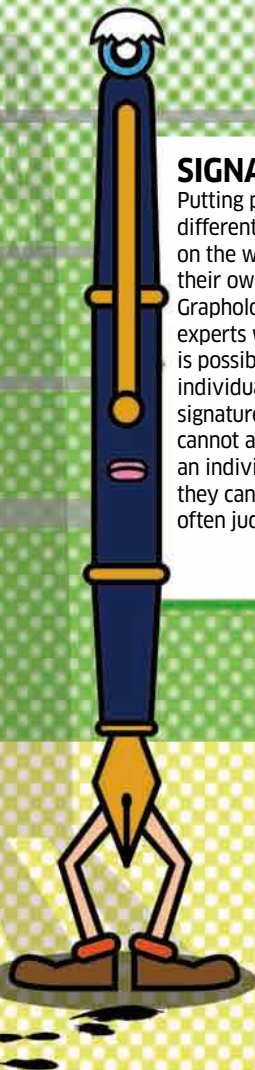
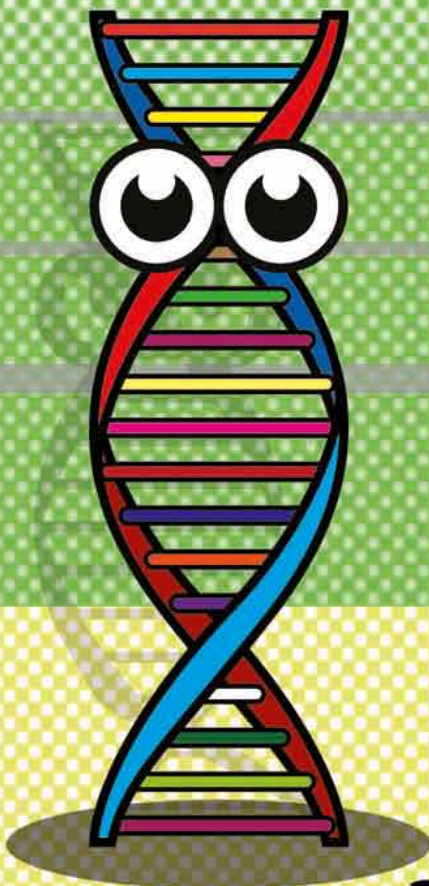
The human voice changes with age and mood, and it is possible to impersonate different accents. Despite this, some vocal tones are unique and cannot be changed. A voiceprint analyzer is used to separate and record these distinctive sounds when a person is speaking. This technology turns the voice into a unique set of patterned lines on a computer.

VEIN STRUCTURE

It's not one for the squeamish, but veins are unique and can be used for identification. Vein-recognition systems scan human hands with a digital camera using near-infrared light. Hemoglobin in the blood absorbs the light, so veins show up clearly as black in the picture. Computer software captures the shapes and positions of the vein structure.

SIGNATURE

Putting pen to paper has very different results depending on the writer. Everyone has their own handwriting style. Graphologists are handwriting experts who believe that it is possible to determine an individual's character by their signature. However, signatures cannot always be used to prove an individual's identity because they can be faked and are often judged only by the eye.



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